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Central Arkansas ALPR Policy Comparison

Prepared: August 12, 2026

Scope: Textual comparison of six supplied law-enforcement policies. This review evaluates what the written policies require; it does not establish how an agency actually operates, whether a policy was formally adopted, or whether required reports and audits were completed.

Executive assessment

The six policies are not equivalent.

- **Cabot is the strongest on the core Arkansas statutory requirements.** It states the 150-day limit, the two mandatory destruction endpoints for data retained with an investigation, the 24-hour update rule, the evidence-of-an-offense sharing threshold, six-month public reporting, 18-month report preservation, privacy rules, and public inspection of the policy.
- **Sherwood is strongest on expressly prohibited uses and documented outcomes.** It uniquely prohibits personal use, unrelated immigration enforcement, minor-violation traffic enforcement, harassment, protected-class-only surveillance, and checking acquaintances or neighbors. It also requires unusually detailed hit dispositions and documented annual audits. Its central weaknesses are an incomplete extended-retention rule and sharing language broader than the Arkansas statutory threshold.
- **Little Rock has the strongest operational controls over user-created hotlists and historical searches.** It requires monthly hotlist audits, removal of stale manual entries, quarterly data audits, and a search reason when the vendor interface supplies a field. Its hit-confirmation language and extended-retention language are weaker than Cabot’s, and its reporting clause contains a drafting contradiction: “monthly biannual.”
- **Jacksonville has useful dissemination logging and hit-disposition provisions, but no six-month public-report requirement or audit schedule appears in the policy.** Those are major accountability omissions.
- **Pulaski County’s 2021 policy tracks Arkansas law reasonably well,** including public reports and destruction deadlines, but lacks a stated audit schedule and meaningful historical-query controls.
- **Pulaski County’s 2025 “Flock Cameras” policy is the most serious governance problem in the set.** Although it contains strong privacy concepts—21-day retention, narrow uses, detailed manual-hotlist records, biannual training, and monthly sampled audits—it repeat-

edly governs an Arkansas sheriff's office under Virginia statutes, Virginia stop-reporting law, Virginia State Police procedures, and Virginia FOIA. The badge graphic even says "Virginia." On its face, this document cannot reliably instruct Arkansas personnel about Arkansas law. The supplied 2025 policy also does not say that it supersedes the 2021 policy, leaving two materially inconsistent Pulaski County documents.

Side-by-side matrix

Agency / policy	Date on document	Default retention	Hit verification	Manual hotlists / query reason	Audit	Six-month public report	Principal concern
Sherwood, 11.08.00	Effective 03/24/2026	150 days; longer for investigation or prosecution	Visual check and ACIC/NCIC confirmation; alert not sole basis without verification, subject to officer-safety qualifier	Audits examine query justification, but no mandatory reason or case number is required at entry	Annual; findings documented and kept 3 years	Yes; kept 18 months	No statutory destruction endpoints for data kept past 150 days; sharing clause does not state "indicates evidence of an offense"
Pulaski County, Policy 43 ("Flock Cameras")	Effective 07/09/2025	21 days under cited Virginia law	Independent reasonable suspicion or independent plate/vehicle confirmation	Strong: supporting facts, vehicle details, legal reason, contact, and case/CAD if available	Every 30 days; samples 5% of queries, downloads, and ALPR stops; reviews sharing settings	No Arkansas six-month report clause	Repeatedly applies Virginia law and Virginia FOIA to an Arkansas agency; no stated supersession of the 2021 policy
Pulaski County, GP 08-018	Effective 06/15/2021	7 days on devices; 150 days on server	Mobile user visually verifies; dispatch immediately verifies fixed alerts through ACIC and creates a CFS	Plates "of interest" may be manually entered; no stated required rationale, case number, or removal deadline	Authorized access monitored, but no audit frequency or sample	Yes; kept 18 months and accessible on request	No scheduled audit; vague manual "of interest" entries; no explicit misuse/prohibited-use section

Agency / policy	Date on document	Default retention	Hit verification	Manual hotlists / query reason	Audit	Six-month public report	Principal concern
Little Rock, G.O. 325	07/08/2026	150 days; case data kept “until no longer needed”	Visual check; ACIC verification only “if practical” before alert-only enforcement	Monthly hotlist audit; one-list norm; stale manual entries removed; search reason required only if interface provides a field	Quarterly data audit; monthly hotlist audit	Yes, but described as “monthly biannual”; kept 18 months	Soft/conditional confirmation and query-reason language; extended-retention destruction endpoints omitted
Jacksonville, 10-28	Reviewed 11/11/2024	150 days; correct destruction endpoints	Visual verification; dispatch/MDT confirmation “when circumstances allow”	Manual-entry reason “should” be documented; historical searches merely follow other policy/law	No schedule stated	No requirement stated	Missing public-report and audit provisions; several key controls use “should”; broad “legitimate law-enforcement purpose” sharing clause
Cabot, 305.1	Implemented 09/13/2022; biennial review	150 days; correct destruction endpoints	Alert not sole basis; plate must be physically located and confirmed visually and through ACIC/NCIC	Only designated users add data; no required rationale, case number, review, or removal rule	No schedule stated	Yes; kept 18 months and public on request	Strong statutory core but no audit mechanism, query justification, detailed manual-hotlist control, or prohibited-use list

Comparison against Arkansas’s statutory floor

Arkansas Act 668 of 2025 amended the Automatic License Plate Reader System Act. For government law-enforcement use, the relevant written-policy benchmarks include:

1. use for the purposes authorized by Arkansas Code § 12-12-1803;
2. a maximum ordinary retention period of 150 days;
3. destruction, for data retained with an ongoing investigation, when an investigation ends without charges or when the related criminal action

- ends;
4. updates every 24 hours when available;
 5. no sale, trade, or exchange, and law-enforcement sharing only when the captured data indicates evidence of an offense;
 6. six-month public statistical reporting and 18-month preservation; and
 7. publicly inspectable rules governing how data is obtained, retained, and destroyed, including retention beyond 150 days. Failure to comply with the policy-publication provision can be grounds to exclude evidence.

Source: Arkansas Act 668 of 2025, especially §§ 12-12-1803 through 12-12-1805 as amended.

Arkansas-law alignment by policy

Cabot most completely reproduces the statutory safeguards. It is the only supplied policy that expressly says the policy itself is open to inspection and copying. Its principal shortcomings are governance controls not expressly supplied by the statute: no audit schedule, no historical-search rationale, and no lifecycle requirements for manually added plates.

Pulaski County 2021 includes the 150-day limit, the correct post-investigation destruction endpoints, six-month public reports, 18-month report retention, and the evidence-of-an-offense sharing threshold. It is less complete on audits, user-created hotlists, prohibited uses, and the 24-hour update requirement.

Sherwood includes the 150-day ceiling, six-month public reports, 18-month report retention, and a general reference to Arkansas Code §§ 12-12-1801 through 1808. But its policy merely permits extended retention when data is associated with “a criminal investigation or prosecution”; it does not say when that retained data must be destroyed. Its sharing clause allows sharing with authorized law-enforcement agencies without expressly limiting that sharing to data indicating evidence of an offense.

Little Rock states the 150-day ceiling, the statutory evidence-of-an-offense sharing threshold, and six-month reporting fields. However, it says case-file data remains “until no longer needed,” rather than using the two concrete statutory endpoints. The phrase “monthly biannual statistical” is internally contradictory, although the next page identifies January–June and July–December reporting periods.

Jacksonville includes the retention ceiling, both destruction endpoints, and the evidence-of-an-offense sharing restriction in its retention section. Its earlier dissemination section nevertheless says data can be shared for “legitimate law enforcement purposes,” which is broader on its face. More importantly, the policy contains no six-month public statistical-report requirement and no scheduled audit.

Pulaski County 2025 should not be treated as an Arkansas-compliance policy without correction. It uses Virginia’s 21-day rule, Virginia’s authorized-purpose test, Virginia stop-reporting law, Virginia agency definitions, Virginia State Police processes, and Virginia FOIA. A 21-day local retention limit could be stricter than Arkansas’s 150-day maximum, but the problem is the source of authority and the policy’s failure to state Arkansas’s reporting, sharing, disclosure, and rule-publication requirements.

Best safeguards found in the set

No single policy contains all of the strongest provisions. A model Central Arkansas policy would combine:

- **Sherwood:** express prohibited-use list, detailed hit outcomes, broad audit scope, and three-year audit-record retention;
- **Pulaski County 2025, after replacing every Virginia reference:** 21-day ordinary retention, narrow enumerated uses, biannual training, detailed manual-hotlist justification, and monthly sampled audits;
- **Pulaski County 2021:** dispatch verification and CFS creation for fixed-camera hits;
- **Little Rock:** monthly hotlist audits, required removal of stale manual entries, and a stated reason for historical searches;
- **Jacksonville:** a secondary-dissemination log for outside sharing; and
- **Cabot:** the clearest statement of Arkansas retention, destruction, sharing, reporting, privacy, and policy-inspection requirements.

Specific questions the policies raise

Pulaski County

1. Was Policy 43 formally adopted, and did it supersede General Policy 08-018?
2. Why does the Arkansas policy use a Virginia sheriff's badge and repeatedly incorporate Virginia law?
3. Were personnel trained under the Arkansas 2021 policy, the Virginia-based 2025 policy, or both?
4. Where are the six-month public reports required by Arkansas law?
5. Has the agency issued a corrected Arkansas policy, and were searches, downloads, stops, sharing, and retention audited during the period of ambiguity?

Sherwood

1. What written rule requires destruction of data retained beyond 150 days at each statutory endpoint?
2. Does the department apply the "indicates evidence of an offense" threshold before sharing data with another law-enforcement agency?
3. Why is entry of a query reason or case/CFS number not mandatory at the time of every historical search?
4. Why are audits annual rather than monthly or quarterly, and what sample size is reviewed?
5. Has every six-month report required by the policy and Arkansas law been completed and made available?

Little Rock

1. Does "monthly biannual" mean monthly compilation with semiannual publication, or something else?
2. Why is ACIC verification only required "if practical" when enforcement rests solely on an ALPR alert?
3. What concrete deletion event replaces "until no longer needed" for case-file data?
4. Why does the search-reason requirement depend on whether the vendor provides a field?

Jacksonville

1. Where is the written six-month public-report requirement?
2. What audit schedule and sample are used for queries, downloads, stops, hotlists, and sharing?
3. Does the broad "legitimate law enforcement purposes" language yield to the narrower evidence-of-an-offense standard in the retention section?
4. Why are alert dispositions and manual-entry reasons phrased as recommendations rather than requirements?

Cabot

1. What recurring audit tests queries, downloads, stops, manual hotlists, retention, and sharing?
2. What reason and case/CAD documentation is required for a historical search or manually entered plate?
3. What process removes a manually entered plate when the investigative basis expires?
4. Has the policy received each biennial review shown on its cover sheet?

Bottom line

For **Arkansas statutory completeness**, Cabot is the best written policy in the supplied set. For **express anti-abuse rules and documented outcomes**, Sherwood is strongest. For **audit frequency and narrow retention**, the concepts in Pulaski County's 2025 document are strongest—

but the document's reliance on Virginia law makes it the weakest instrument for lawful Arkansas governance until corrected. Little Rock has the best hotlist lifecycle controls, Jacksonville has a useful dissemination log, and Pulaski County's 2021 policy remains more coherent under Arkansas law than its 2025 replacement or companion document.

The central lesson is that policy quality should not be judged by whether a department has an ALPR policy. It should be judged by whether the policy binds users with clear purposes, records every search and manual plate entry, independently verifies alerts, destroys data at definite deadlines, limits sharing, produces public reports, and subjects actual use to frequent, documented audits.

Documents reviewed

- Sherwood Police Department, Policy 11.08.00, Automatic License Plate Reader (ALPR) Policy, effective March 24, 2026 (5 pages).
- Pulaski County Sheriff's Office, Policy 43, Flock Cameras (ALPR), effective July 9, 2025 (5 PDF pages; cover states 6 total pages).
- Pulaski County Sheriff's Office, General Policy 08-018, License Plate Reader (LPR), effective June 15, 2021 (5 pages).
- Little Rock Police Department, General Order 325, License Plate Reader (LPR), dated July 8, 2026 (4 pages).
- Jacksonville Police Department, Policy 10-28, License Plate Readers, reviewed November 11, 2024 (3 pages).
- Cabot Police Department, Policy 305.1, License Plate Reader(s), implemented September 13, 2022 (4 pages).

This is a policy and governance analysis, not legal advice or a finding about actual agency conduct.